Welcome & Lunch

HE strategic session 2

13 November 2025

Agenda

Time	Topic
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch
13:00 – 13:30	Reflecting on Session 1: vision, mission & key Actions
13:30 – 15:15	Activity 1: What do we do and how do we measure achievement of our mission?
15:15 – 15:30	*Break*
15:30 – 16:15	Activity 2: Connecting HE to the faculty themes
16:15 – 16:30	Next steps
16:30	End of session

Summary session 1

Vision:

We envision safe, resilient, and sustainable urbanised deltas, where people and ecosystems thrive. Our focus is on enhancing the design and performance of hydraulic systems, improving infrastructure, strengthening climate adaptation and hazard resilience, and accelerating the transition to clean energy.

Mission:

We fulfil this vision through world-leading education, research and valorisation in the field of hydraulic engineering. Through our unique education we empower the next generation of hydraulic engineers to bring new knowledge and innovation to the field.

Our research on urbanised deltas is grounded in a deep understanding of hydraulic processes and system dynamics, synergising theory, modelling, fieldwork and laboratory experiments. We achieve real world impact and address global challenges by actively collaborating with governments, industry, and academic partners to deliver practical and sustainable engineering solutions for society.

We embrace the TU Delft values by fostering an academic leadership and working environment that promotes diversity, inclusion, equity, integrity and courage.

Give feedback on the document!

Summary session 1

Key Actions Toward 2035

Across all groups and written inputs, several priorities emerged for the coming decade:

- Strengthen internal collaboration and coherence, reducing silos between sections and functions.
- Enhance visibility and outreach – both nationally (and internationally.
- Invest in laboratory (including fieldwork) and digital infrastructure to remain at the forefront of experimental and computational methods.
- Improve financial management and administrative support structures, to reduce workload.
- Foster interdisciplinary education with hands-on learning, AI integration, and global relevance.
- Promote a positive and inclusive departmental culture with room for excellence, creativity, and individual growth.

Activity 1: What do we do and how do we measure achievement of our mission?

The 7 HE Achievements:

1. We conduct scientifically excellent and societally relevant research that has impact.
2. Our MSc and PhD graduates are recognised as top professionals and take on leadership roles in academia, industry, and government.
3. We maintain strong partnerships with industry and public stakeholders, co-developing innovative solutions with measurable impact.
4. Our education is world leading. (should it be open to people beyond TU Delft?).
5. We operate world-class, unique lab and field research infrastructure, and have realized a modern, sustainable facility in Delft.
6. We have a global presence and influence.
7. The department is a proactive, efficient, inclusive team that supports TU Delft values. We operate a strong, supportive and healthy working culture.

Activity 1- What do we do and how do we measure achievement of our mission?

Round 1

Instructions:
Each group will work on of the seven department achievements.
Discuss and write on the flipover:

- **What we do:** concrete actions, activities or initiatives that contribute to this goal.
- **How we measure success:** which criteria, indicators or outcomes show that we are achieving this goal?
- Please make your notes clear and specific. The next group will review and give feedback in the following rounds.
  You have **30 minutes** for this first round.

Activity 1- What do we do and how do we measure achievement of our mission?

Round 2: review & reflect

Instructions:
Read what the previous group has written on the flipover:

- **Review** their ideas as a group. What do you agree or disagree with?
- **Add or refine,** complete what's missing, make criteria more specific, or suggest alternative ways to measure success.

You have **10 minutes** before moving to the next table.

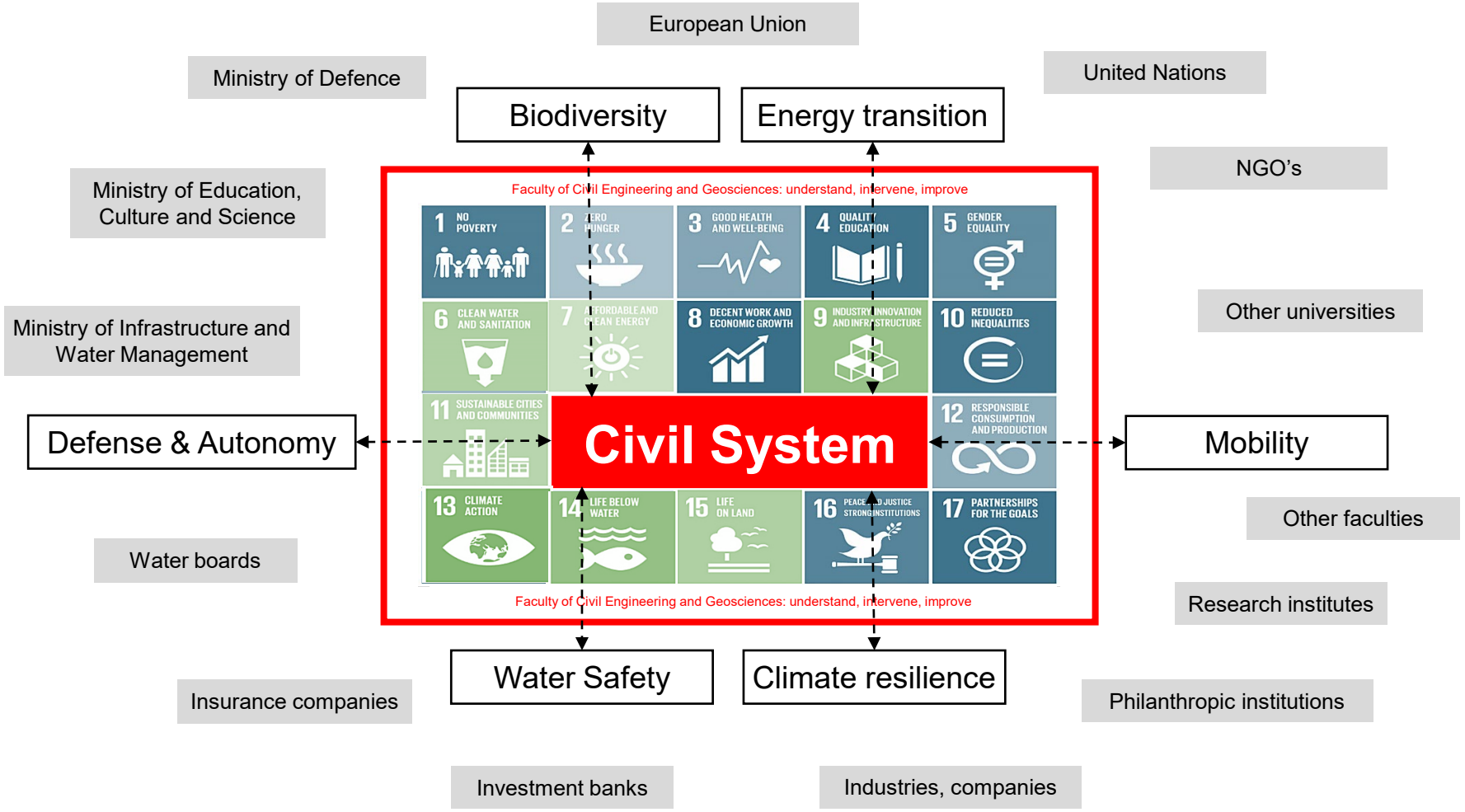
Rotation schedule

	Group 1	Group 2	Group 3	Group 4	Group 5	Group 6	Group 7
13:30	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	A7
14:00	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	A7	A1
14:10	A3	A4	A5	A6	A7	A1	A2
14:20	A4	A5	A6	A7	A1	A2	A3
14:30	Break	Break	Break	Break	Break	Break	Break
14:45	A5	A6	A7	A1	A2	A3	A4
14:55	A6	A7	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5
15:05	A7	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6
15:15	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	A7

BREAK TIME

Activity 2: Connecting HE to the faculty themes

The Faculty of Civil Engineering and Geosciences focuses on understanding, intervening in, and improving the civil system which is the collection of assets, measures, and requirements necessary for a functioning society in which citizens can live and survive.



TU Delft Faculty of Civil Engineering and Geosciences

Activity 2 - Connecting HE to the Faculty Themes

Instructions:

- Per group there are six flipover sheets: one for each faculty theme.
- As a group, write down:
  - For each of the faculty's themes describe our current activities (research/education/valorisation).
  - For each of the faculty's themes describe our desired future activities (research/education/valorisation).
  - Is there a faculty theme missing?
- You have 30 minutes for this exercise.

Next steps

- We'll process your input from both activities and share a summary with the department.
- **Next session – 11 December:**
  - Dive deeper into the themes within HE
  - Explore how we are organised as a department and how this supports our ambitions

End of the session:

Thank you for your input!